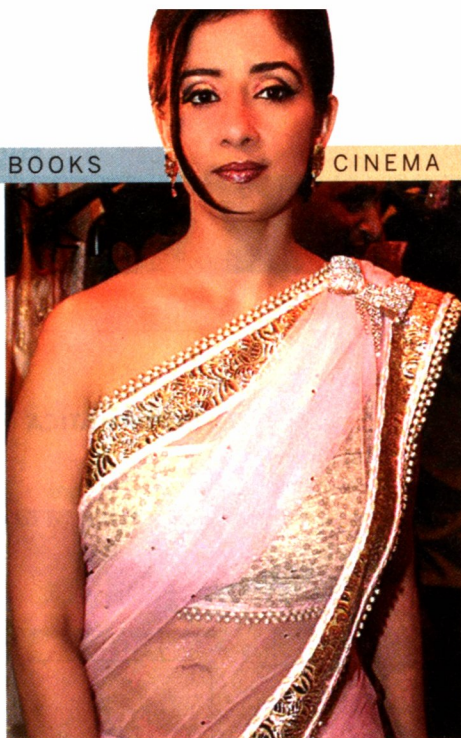


IMPORT MANIA

The Bhatt's, it seems, can never get enough of Pakistan. After Meera, their latest object of attention is **Monalisa**, who is touted as the Smriti Irani of Pakistan. She plays a young woman from Lahore in Pooja Bhatt's *Kajraare*, opposite another favourite, as a music director so far, Himesh Reshammiya. "We cast her for we wanted someone who looked absolutely believable playing a Pakistani," says Pooja. Don't they always say that?



MAMMA MIA

Manisha Koirala has finally come of age. At 39, she has graduated to playing an on-screen mom to an 18-year-old Hansika Motwani in *Mappillai*, a Tamil remake of the 1989 Rajinikanth-starrer. While contemporaries Raveena Tandon and Karishma Kapoor are trying to keep their glamour alive, Koirala seems willing to give it all up. Maybe she will be better off making a quick dash down the aisle with her Nepali beau.

Taking Wing

Anurag Basu's *Kites* did not fly too high. With his next film being *Silence*, he is using the time to get talking, returning to his roots in television. After delivering some of television's bestsellers like *Tara*, *Koshish*—*Ek Aasha* and *Love Story*, Basu chats up celebrities on a Bengali talk show, *Ke Hobe Biggest Fan*. Here's what we would like him to ask:

Bipasha Basu Will you marry John Abraham?

Sushmita Sen Will you marry at all?

Mithun Chakraborty Are you planning to make a third launch film for Mimoh?



MANDAR DEODHAR/www.indiatodayimages.com

After Effects

Who **Nikki Randhawa Haley**, a Sarah Palin favourite and frontrunner in the Republican primary for governor of South Carolina, born to Sikh immigrants from Amritsar.

What Her former publicist, Will Folks, decided to come clean, claiming in his blog that he had an 'inappropriate physical relationship' with her three years ago.

When Fifteen days before the South Carolina primary. Haley is not thrilled, considering she has been married for 13 years. "I have been honest to my husband," she says.



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